Prior Authorization Requests – Quick Guide

AZ Blue (use these request options for most plans – see "Exceptions" rows below)	
AZ Blue prior authorization requests (Unscheduled admissions require notification within 48 hours)	Availity Essentials™ provider portal (includes status dashboard) *Although the Availity request tool is different from the AZ standardized forms, requests submitted through the Availity portal will be considered valid.* Arizona standardized forms are available on our Prior Auth page. Gold Card: Use the Availity provider portal or call hotline: 602-864-4811 (for EviCore, use the EviCore provider portal). 24/7 Assistance for urgent issues and transfers to post-acute care Email us at UtilMgmt@azblue.com or call the numbers below for timely assistance with imminent treatment needs and transfers from acute to post-acute care facilities. Most AZ Blue plans: 844-995-2583 State of Arizona employer group plans (prefixes SYD and S3Z): 866-287-1980 *Note: Some large groups have customized extended hours. Check the member ID card for specific prior authorization and contact information.*
EviCore prior authorization requests (Most AZ Blue commercial plans and all AZ Blue-administered Medicare Advantage plans)	EviCore provider hub *Although the EviCore request tool is different from the AZ standardized forms, requests submitted through EviCore's online tool will be considered valid.* Provider resources: EviCore resource page.

Exceptions:

1. ACA StandardHealth with Health Choice plan (member ID prefix IAZ)
   Access resources via the Health Choice prior auth webpage (or call 800-322-8670).
2. AZ Blue and TPA jointly administered plans (member ID prefixes K8Y, K8Z, MKQ, NBT, and PTP)
   Call the prior authorization phone number on the back of the member's ID card.
3. BlueCard® (out-of-area) plans (members from other Blue Plans)
   Use Availity provider portal (or call the prior authorization phone number on the back of the member's ID card).
4. CHS group plans (no member ID prefix; these are large, self-funded employer groups that use a third-party administrator)
   Call the prior authorization phone number on back of the member's ID card.
5. FEP plans (member ID prefix R)
   Use Availity provider portal (or for non-postal service plans, call 800-345-7562; For postal service plans, call 888-585-8922)
6. Medicare Advantage (MA) plans (member ID prefix M2K) – Unscheduled admissions require notification within 24 hours.
   Use Availity provider portal (or MA prior auth fax form). EviCore: EviCore.com/provider.
   Urgent issues after hours: Call 888-905-1172.
   Members attributed to Optum Health Network Arizona (OHNAZ): optumproportal.com/home.
   Members attributed to Arizona Priority Care (AZPC): azconnect.azprioritycare.com/production.
7. Medicare Supplement plans (member ID prefix XBS)
   Medicare Supplement plans align with CMS for coverage and medical necessity determinations. If a member's plan covers benefits for foreign travel emergency services, AZ Blue will determine medical necessity.
8. Strategic Hub plans w Blue Plan Partner (member ID prefixes AOZ, AZI, AZK, and IVR)
   Use the Strategic Hub My Insurance Manager provider portal (or call 888-376-6544; Mental health/SUD: 800-868-1032).

Inpatient Notification and Prior Authorization Requirements – Quick Guide

NON-EMERGENCY ADMISSIONS		
Type of Benefit Plan	**Prior Authorization**	**Admission Notification**
AZ Blue Commercial Group and Individual/Family Plans	Required only for admissions related to codes that require prior authorization .	When prior authorization is not required, pre-admission notification is required. Post-admission notification is always required within 48 hours: • Online: Use the Availity portal • Fax the face sheet to 844-263-2272 • Call 602-864-4320 or 800-232-2345
Certain Self-Funded Group Plans (prefixes PXO, SWB, SNK, SYD, S3Z, TYW)	Required for all non-emergency admissions except maternity admissions.	
ACA StandardHealth with Health Choice Plan (prefix IAZ)	Required.	Post-admission notification required within 24 hours: Call 1-800-322-8670.
Federal Employee Program® (FEP®) Plans (prefix R)	Precertification or prior approval required for all non-emergency admissions except maternity admissions for a routine delivery (stays longer than 48 hours after vaginal delivery or 96 hours after cesarean require precertification of the additional days).	Post-admission notification is always required within 48 hours: • Online: Use the Availity portal • Call 602-864-4102 or 800-345-7562 • Postal service plans: 888-585-8922
Medicare Advantage Plans administered by AZ Blue	Required only for admissions related to codes that require prior authorization.	When prior authorization is not required, pre-admission notification is required. Post-admission notification is always required within 24 hours: • Online: Use the Availity portal • Fax: Use the MA Request Fax Form • Call 800-446-8331
Medicare Advantage Plans administered by Optum Health Network Arizona (OHNAZ) or Arizona Priority Care (AZPC)	Notification required within 24 hours (check prior authorization requirements): • For OHNAZ: Go to optumproportal.com/home or call 877-370-2845. • For AZPC: Fax to 480-499-8779 or call 480-499-8720.	
BlueCard® (Out-of-Area) Plans	Call the number on the back of the ID card (member's home Blue Plan).	
TPA-Administered Group Plans (prefixes K8Y, K8Z, MKQ, NBT, PTP)	Call the number on the back of the ID card (UM is administered by a TPA).	
Strategic Hub Plans w Blue Plan Partner (prefixes AOZ, AZI, AZK, IVR)	Use the Strategic Hub My Insurance Manager portal (or call 888-376-6544; Mental health/SUD: 800-868-1032).	

TRANSFERS TO DIFFERENT LEVELS OF CARE		
Type of Transfer	**Prior Authorization**	**Admission Notification**
Observation → Inpatient	N/A	When prior authorization is not required, pre-admission notification is required. Post-admission notification is always required (see above for time frame and notification options by type of plan).
Acute Care → Post-Acute Care	Required, except for plans eligible for our SNF Quick Transfer program (most commercial plans and the Medicare Advantage plans we administer).	
Acute Care Facility → Another Acute Care Facility (same or lower level of care)	Required.	
Different Levels of Care (within the same facility)	N/A	N/A